

NBA Analytics Project — Final Award Set

Awards and Award Teams — Seasons 2019-20 through 2024-25

Awards Determined Yearly

- MVP — Most Valuable Player (Team Record Influence)
- DPOY — Defensive Player of the Year
- OPOY — Offensive Player of the Year

Note: 65-Game minimum eligibility rule applies from 2023-24 onward to all three awards above.

MVP (No Team Record Influence), 6MOY, ROY, MIP, and COY were evaluated during development and ultimately cut from the final award set. See “Cut Awards & Award Teams” below for the reasoning behind each.

Fictional Individual Awards

Independent of team record.

- Best Player
- Best Scorer (efficiency factored in)
- Best Playmaker

Award Teams Determined Yearly

- All-NBA Teams — Positioned (2 Guards, 2 Forwards, 1 Center) prior to 2023-24; Positionless (Top 15, in tiers of 5) from 2023-24 onward

Note: 65-Game minimum applies from 2023-24 onward.

All-Defense Teams (Positioned and Positionless), All-Rookie Teams, and All-Offensive Team were evaluated and cut. See “Cut Awards & Award Teams” below.

Fictional Team Awards

Independent of team record.

- Best Offensive Team
- Best Defensive Team
- Most Efficient Team
- Best Overall Team

Cut Awards & Award Teams — What Was Removed, and Why

Dropped rather than shipped with an asterisk. Each of the following produced results that couldn't be defended, or added no distinct analytical value once the final award set took shape.

Award / Team	Reason for Cut
MVP (No Team Record Influence)	Redundant once MVP (Team Influence) was retained — real MVP voting already factors in team success, so a separate no-team comparison target added no distinct value.
6MOY (Sixth Man of the Year)	Box-score data can't reliably distinguish bench scorers from rotation players at the precision a defensible award requires.
MIP (Most Improved Player)	Year-over-year delta-percentile calculations proved statistically unreliable across season boundaries.
COY (Coach of the Year)	Built on the same year-over-year delta structure as MIP ($\Delta\text{Win}\%$, $\Delta\text{Team Offense}$, $\Delta\text{Team Defense}$) — hit the same reliability problem.
Early standalone “Best Defensive Player” metric (distinct from DPOY)	Rate-stat inflation at low minutes produced winners that weren't defensible.
All-Defense Teams (Positioned & Positionless)	Mathematically redundant with DPOY at wider rank cutoffs.
All-Offensive Team	Mathematically redundant with OPOY at wider rank cutoffs, for the same reason.
ROY (Rookie of the Year)	Cut from the final set; specific rationale not separately documented elsewhere in this project's history — confirm before citing a reason.
All-Rookie Teams	Used the same formula as ROY by design; cut alongside it. Specific rationale not separately documented — confirm before citing a reason.

Tiebreakers & Percentile Rules

Tiebreakers

Applied in this order: 1) Games Played — 2) Minutes Played — 3) Team Success Score — 4) Higher seed.

Percentile Formula

Percentile	$((\text{Total Players} - 1) / (\text{Rank} - 1)) \times 100$
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For stats where a lower raw value is better (TOV%, DRtg, Opponent FG%, etc.): Adjusted Percentile = 100 – Percentile.